

GEOGRAPHY

PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY



CLIMATOLOGY

MODULE – 40

WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES
THE BRITISH CLIMATE

(PART- 1)

FUN FACTS ABOUT BRITISH CLIMATE!

THE THREE MAIN FEATURES OF THE BRITISH CLIMATE

- The bad reputation of Britain's climate **is due to** its changeability.
- There is a saying that



Britain doesn't have a climate, it only has weather

- But English weather is never the same **two days running**.
- One day it rains, the next day it may be sunny and then it may be cold again.
- So, we may say that the British climate has three main features: it is mild, humid and changeable.

1. mild

2. humid

3. changeable



COLD ZONE Arctic Circle, $66\frac{1}{2}^{\circ}$	<u>Arctic or Polar Type</u> Tundra vegetation, mosses, lichens			90°
COOL TEMPERATE ZONE	Western Margin <u>British type</u> Deciduous forests	Central Continent <u>Siberian type</u> Evergreen, coniferous forests	Eastern Margin <u>Laurentian type</u> Mixed forests	65° N
WARM TEMPERATE ZONE	<u>Mediterranean type</u> Mediterranean Forests & shrubs	<u>Steppe type</u> Steppe temperate grassland	<u>China type</u> Warm wet forests	45° N
Tropic of Cancer $23\frac{1}{2}^{\circ}$ HOT ZONE	<u>Hot desert</u> Desert vegetation	<u>Sudan type</u> Savanna, tropical grassland	<u>Monsoonal type</u> Monsoon forests	30° N
EQUATORIAL ZONE	<u>Hot Wet Equatorial Climate</u> Equatorial rain forests			10° N 0°

WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

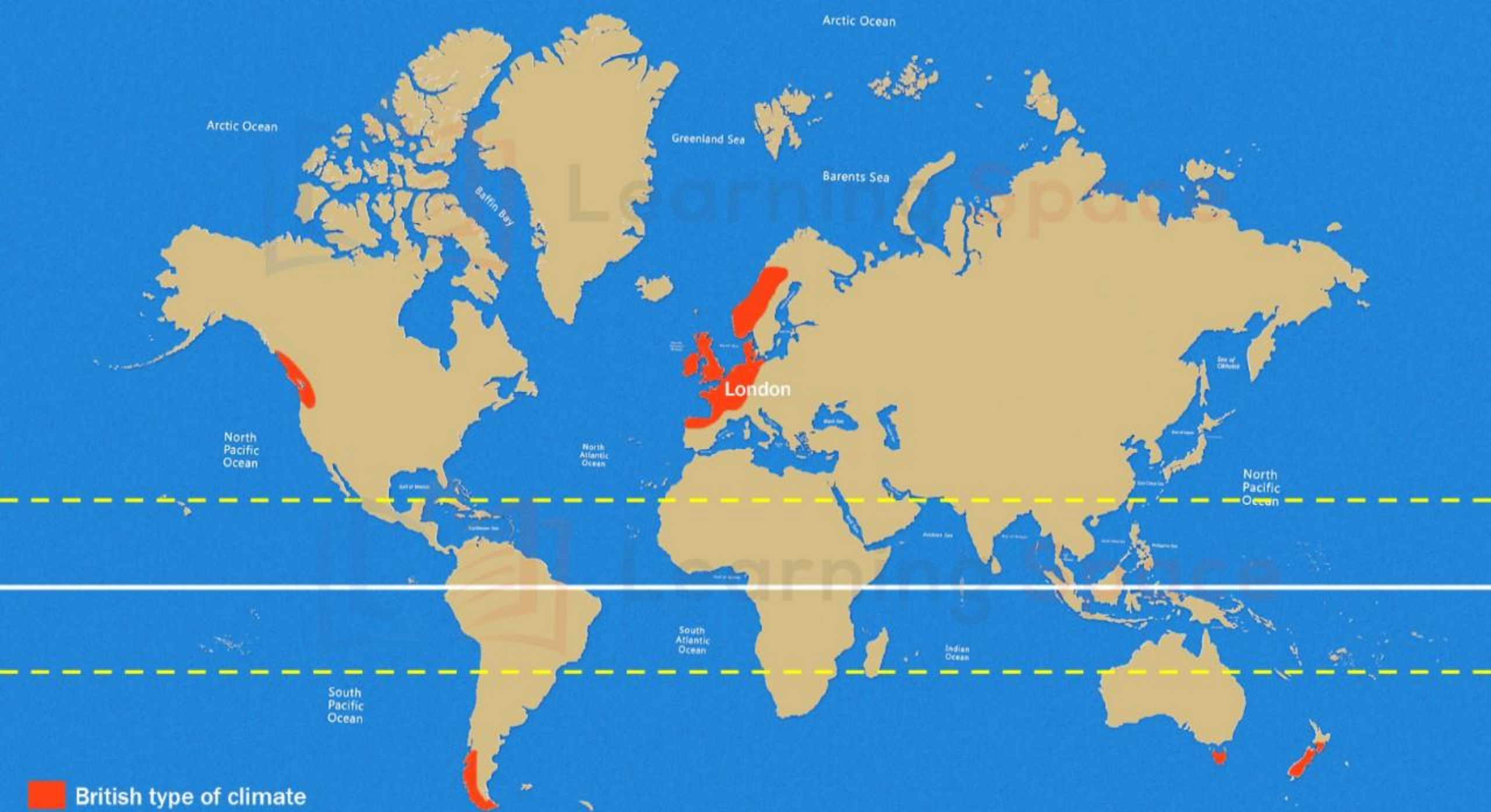
DISTRIBUTION

- 1 The cool temperate western margins are under the permanent influence of the Westerlies all round the year.



- 2 They are also regions of much cyclonic activity, typical of Britain and are thus said to experience the British type of Climate.

- 3 From Britain, the climatic belt stretches far inland into the low lands of North-West Europe, including such regions as northern and western France, Belgium, the Netherlands, Denmark, western Norway and also north-western Iberia.



WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

DISTRIBUTION



*British climate in North-Western
Europe and British Columbia.*

4

There is so much oceanic influence on both the temperature and the precipitation that the climate is also referred to as the **North-West European Maritime Climate**.

5

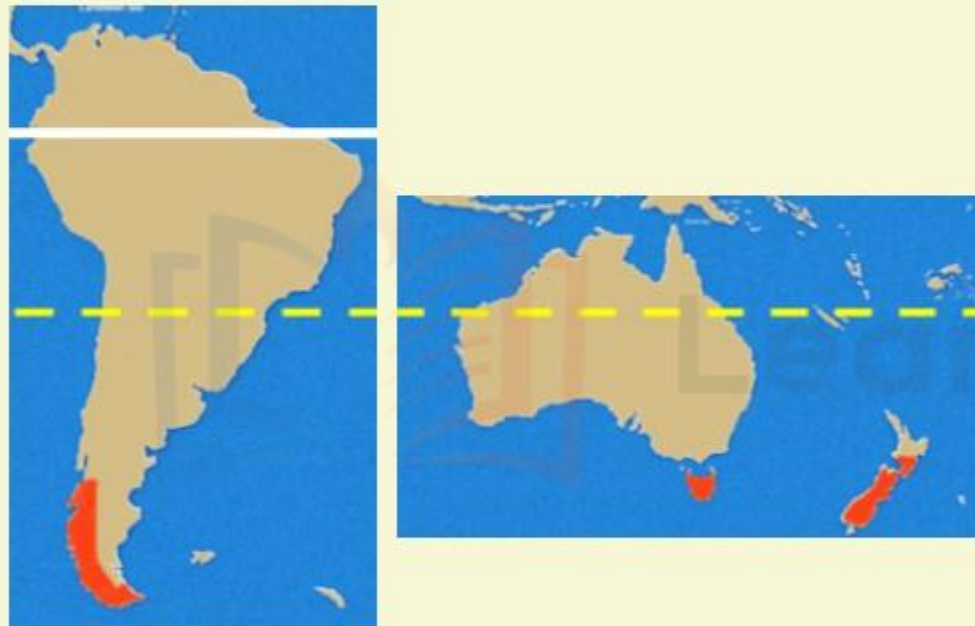
In North America, the high Rockies prevent the on-shore Westerlies from penetrating far inland and the British type of climate is confined mainly to the coastlands of British Columbia.

WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

DISTRIBUTION



British climate in southern Chile, New Zealand, Tasmania shown in the figure

6

In Southern Hemisphere, the climate is experienced in southern Chile, Tasmania and most parts of New Zealand, particularly in South island.

7

The surrounding large expanses of water have increased the maritime nature of the climate here.

SAMPLE QUESTION

Which among the following climatic region influence by Westerlies all round the year?

- a) Cool Temperate Western Margin Climate
- b) Arctic or Polar or Tundra Climate
- c) Taiga of Siberian Climate
- d) Mediterranean Climate

Answer: A

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2. humid

3. changeable

EXPLANATION

- Westerlies are the prevailing winds ie most dominant winds throughout the year.
- The most consistent thing about British type of climate is their **INCONSISTENCY!**
- Influenced by many air masses and westerlies, they will have rain throughout the year.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

CLIMATE

a

TEMPERATURE

1 The mean annual temperatures are usually between 4°C and 15°C .

2 Heat waves, as they are popularly called, (that is a short spell of warm summer days) are a welcome feature in such cool temperate latitudes, where people do not often see enough of sun.

3 The climate is ideal for maximum comfort and mental alertness.

4 People can for work long hours without feeling drowsy and lethargic as they do in the tropics.

5 There appears to be some direct relationship between climate and man's output of work.

6 It is no wonder that the cool temperate regions are some of the most advanced parts of the world.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

CLIMATE

a

TEMPERATURE



7

Winters are abnormally mild, and no stations actually record mean January temperatures below freezing-point in north-western Europe.

8

This is attributable to the warming effect of the North Atlantic Drift.

9

The oceanic influences not only keep the winters very mild but also keep the summers cool.

10

Some geographers have described these places as the favored isles which has much truth in it.

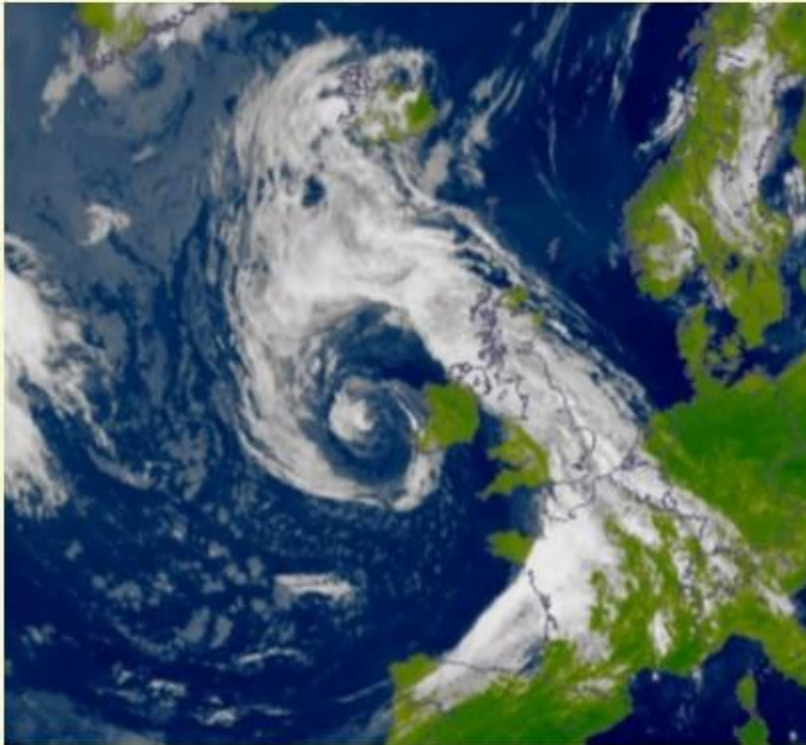
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THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

CLIMATE

b

PRECIPITATION



Cyclone formation occurring in UK

- 1 The British type of climate has adequate rainfall throughout the year with a tendency towards a slight winter or autumn maximum from cyclonic sources.
- 2 Since the rain-bearing winds come from the west, the western margins have the heaviest rainfall.
- 3 The amount decreases eastwards with increasing distance from the sea.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

CLIMATE

c

SEASONS

1 As in other temperate regions, there are **four distinct seasons** in the British climate type.

2 Light snowfalls can be expected in the **winter months** normally only of short duration because of the comparatively mild weather.

3 But, over the highlands such as **Scandinavian Mountains** and the **American Rockies**, snowfall is **heavy** and feeds the mountain glaciers that move down the valleys.

4 Winter is the season of cloudy skies, foggy and misty mornings and many rainy days from the passing depressions.

5 Out at sea, gales are frequent and can be dangerous to shipping.

6 Spring is the **driest and the most refreshing season** when people emerge from the depressing winter to see everything becoming green again.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

CLIMATE

c

SEASONS



7

This is followed by the long, sunny summer. With the roar of gusty winds and the fall of 'golden' leaves, autumn is ushered in, and the cycle repeats itself.

8

This type of climate with its four distinct seasons is something that is conspicuously absent in the tropics.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

NATURAL VEGETATION



- 1 The natural vegetation of this climatic type is **deciduous forest**. The trees shed their leaves in the cold season.
- 2 This an adaption for **protecting themselves against the winter snow and frost**.
- 3 Shedding begins in autumn, the fall season, during which the leaves fall and naked branches present a very interesting scene.
- 4 The deciduous trees have typical rounded outline with thick trunks and out-spreading branches **that yield valuable temperate hardwood**.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

NATURAL VEGETATION



5

Some of the more common species include oak, elm, ash, birch, beech, poplar and hornbeam.

6

Unlike the equatorial forests, the deciduous trees **occur in pure stands and have greater lumbering value** from the commercial point of view.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

NATURAL VEGETATION

7 The open nature of the forests with sparse undergrowth is useful in logging operations.

8 Easy penetration means much cost can be saved in the movement of the logs.

9 The deciduous hardwoods are excellent for both fuel and industrial purposes.

10 In Tasmania, the temperate eucalypts are also extensively felled for the lumbering industry.

11 Higher up the mountains in the Scandinavian highlands, the Rockies, southern Andes and the Southern Alps of New Zealand, the deciduous trees are generally replaced by the conifers which can survive a higher altitude, a lower temperature and poorer soils.

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